

Kaiyi Wen

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Employment

Postdoctoral Fellow, Woody L. Hunt College of Business, University of Texas at El Paso, 2025 -

Education

Ph.D. Economics, Binghamton University, 2025.

M.A. Economics, Boston University, 2020.

B.A. Economics, China Agricultural University & University of Colorado Denver, 2018.

Fields of Interest

Environmental Economics; Health Economics; Labor Economics

Publications

Road Infrastructure, Foreign Direct Investment, and Economic Growth in China, with Yushang Wei. *Research in Transportation Economics*, 119 (2026), 101833. DOI: 10.1016/j.retrec.2026.101833.

PrEP Use and Risk of Sexually Transmitted Infections Among U.S. College Students, with Yichu Li, Hyeran Chung, and Xiaolong Hou. *Journal of American College Health*, 74(7) (2026), 1937–1943. DOI: 10.1080/07448481.2026.2626143.

Working Papers

As Time Goes By: Redlining, Kinship, and Environmental Justice, with Neha Khanna. Minor Revision (2nd round) at *Land Economics*.

Sensory Pollution and Mental Health: Evidence from Roadway Noise and Nighttime Light, with Neha Khanna, and Yushang Wei. Under Review.

Behind Environmental Injustice: Disparate Siting and Post-Siting Migration of Fossil Fuel Power Plants, with Ruohao Zhang and Huan Li. Under Review.

Taxing Addiction in Hard Times: Cigarette Taxes and Smoking During Recessions, with Hyeran Chung, Xiaolong Hou, Yichu Li, and Yeongmi Jeong. Submitted.

Energy Transition and Mental Health, with Jancy Liu, Dylan Brewer, and Yueming Qiu.

The Hidden Toll: Public Health Burden of Illicit Opioid Market Shifts, with Xiaolong Hou, Yichu Li, Donglan Zhang, and Zhuo Chen.

Selected Work in Progress

Rough Waters: Flood Zone Reclassification and Community Stability, with Yushang Wei, and Michael Coury.

Highway Noise Pollution and Infant Health Outcomes: Evidence from California, with Huan Li, Ruohao Zhang, and Neha Khanna.

The Persistence in Environmental Exposure: Evidence from Anchoring, with Huan Li, Ruohao Zhang, and Neha Khanna.

The Impact of Health Insurance Transition: Evidence from El Paso, with Hyeran Chung.

Spousal BMI and Mental Health: An Instrumental Variables Approach, with Xiaolong Hou, Yichu Li, Yeongmi Jeong, and Zhuo Chen.

Conference Presentations

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) 2026 Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA, November 2026 (scheduled)

2026 Chinese Economist Society (CES) North America Conference, Atlanta, GA, March 2026

Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE) 2025 Summer Conference, Santa Ana Pueblo, NM, May 2025

Eastern Economic Association (EEA) 51st Annual Meeting, New York, NY, February 2025

American Economic Association (AEA/ASSA) 2025 Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA, January 2025

Global Labor Organization (GLO) Global Conference (Virtual), December 2024

Southern Economic Association (SEA) 94th Annual Meeting, Washington, DC, November 2024

The Heartland Environmental and Resource Economics (HERE) Workshop, Champaign, IL, October 2024

Online Summer Workshop in Environment, Energy, and Transportation (OSWEET), September 2024

2024 Northeastern Agricultural and Resource Economics Association (NAREA) Annual Meeting and Workshop, Rehoboth Beach, DE, June 2024

Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE) 2024 Summer Conference, Washington, DC, May 2024

2024 Chinese Economist Society (CES) North America Conference, Lewisburg, PA, March 2024

* American Economic Association (AEA/ASSA) 2024 Annual Meeting, San Antonio, TX, January 2024 (NSF-RA project was accepted for presentation)

2023 Health Information National Trends Survey (HINTS) Data Users Conference, Bethesda, MD, September 2023

Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE) 2023 Summer Conference, Portland, ME, June 2023

* indicates attendee, instead of presenter

Awards and Scholarships

Economics Professional Development Research Grant for outstanding performance and departmental contributions, 2025

Teaching Assistant Fellowship; Binghamton University, 2025

National Science Foundation Research Assistant Fellowship; Supervisor: Neha Khanna, 2023-2025

Teaching Assistant Fellowship; Binghamton University, 2020-2023

Graduate Tuition Scholarship; Binghamton University, 2020-2025

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record - Binghamton University

Econ 160: Principles of Microeconomics, Spring 2025

Graduate Teaching Assistant - Binghamton University

Econ 696G: Industrial Organization I, Fall 2024

Econ 466: Introduction to Econometrics, Fall 2022

Econ 454: Economics of Corporations, Spring 2022

Econ 461: Game Theory, Fall 2021

Econ 360: Microeconomic Theory, Fall 2020, Spring 2021

Professional Activities and Services

Journal referee: Journal of Environmental Economics and Management (×1), Journal of Environmental Economics and Policy (×2), Empirical Economics (×2), Environmental Economics and Policy Studies (×1), Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (×1)

Conference referee: AAEA Annual Conference (×2), AERE Summer Conference (×1), NAREA Annual Meeting & Workshop (×1), SEA Annual Meeting (×1)

Programming Skills

Stata, R, Python, ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, Google Earth Engine, Latex

Miscellaneous

Language: English (Fluent), Chinese (Native)

Citizenship: Chinese (US visa status: F-1 OPT)

References

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